

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 16

**PREVIOUS MAINS QUESTIONS
& PRACTICE QUESTIONS**



Q 01

**“Firoz Tughluq was regarded as an ideal Muslim king of medieval times.” Comment.
(10 marks)(150 words)**

Firoz Shah Tughlaq is called the Ideal Muslim king as he took several initiatives to promote and propagate Islamic religion.

IDEAL MUSLIM KING: FEATURES

- One whose rule is based on Shariyat laws.
- One who promotes protects and defend his Muslim subjects.
- Allows only those activities, which are permitted under the tenets of Islam.
- One who promotes charity and welfarism.

STEPS TAKEN BY FERROZ TUGHLAQ.

- He abolished several taxes and imposed only those permitted under Shariyat Law
- Reimposed Jaziya even on Bramhins.
- Promoted religious conversion into Islam by both fear and favour.
- Gave capital punishment to blasphemous, crimes and actively undertook temple destruction.
- Established Diwan i Khairat (Charity Department), built several hospitals and gave money to Muslims girls for marriage.

FEATURES WHICH CAN NOT BE CALLED AS IDEAL

- Imposition of Zajiya meant he would protect the Hindu subjects, but he failed in several instances
- Imposed tax on irrigation, though not allowed by Shariyat
- Islam prohibits drinking and intoxication, allows only 4 wives. Feroz violated both these aspects

Thus, Feroz Shah being an Ideal Muslim king is true only in degrees and not in absolute terms. As such Firoz Shah more closer to Sikander Lodhi than Akbar in his approach.

Q 02**Discuss in brief the Judicial administration of the Delhi Sultanate.(10 marks)(150 words)****JUDICIAL SYSTEM OF DELHI SULTANATE**

- Sultan is the power centre in the sultanate and his word was the rule of law. However, an elaborate judicial system both formal and informal was also present.

JUDICIAL AUTHORITY

- Sultan was the final appellate authority
- Below him, a network of Qazis, Maulvis and Ulemas etc. functioned as judicial institution.
- They gave justice based on Shariyat law.
- Panchayats in villages acted as judicial institution for Hindus.

NATURE OF PUNISHMENT:

- Criminal justice system was extremely harsh and barbaric.
- An eye for an eye, blood money, capital punishment, amputation of limbs was prevalent.
- Civil Justice System was based on Shariyat.
- Hindu subjects were given choice to convert to Islam when facing death sentence.
- Thus the justice system of the Delhi Sultanate was elaborate hierarchical and had both criminals and civil parts.

Justice Administration was not uniform across different dynasties evident from the facts that Ulemmas exercised varying influence and Jazia Law getting continuously changed.

JUSTICE ADMINISTRATION



OFFICE OF QAZI – JUSTICE ADMINISTRATION

- The Sultan was the highest judicial authority.
- Qazi-ul-quzar was the Chief Judicial officer.
- There was a Qazi in every town.
- Muslim law **Sharia** was followed in civil matters.

NOTE:

- Hindus were governed by their personal law and their cases were dispensed by the panchayats.
- Criminal law was based on the rules and regulations of the Sultan.

Q 03

Examine the economic regulations of Allauddin Khalji and its impact.(12.5marks)(200 words)

ECONOMIC REGULATIONS AND REFORMS DONE BY ALAUDIN CONSISTED OF 2 MACRO PATHS

- a) Revenue reforms
- b) Market Reforms

THE OBJECTIVE WAS :

- to provide cash salary to the soldiers
- maintain a mammoth centralized standing army loyal only to the sultan.

a) Revenue reforms

- Intermediaries were removed in revenue collection.
- Survey & measurement i.e. scientific assessment was done to calculate the land revenue.
- Grants and exemptions to Ulemas, nobles & middlemen were removed.

B) MARKET REFORMS

1. Prices of the products were fixed
2. Market divided into three parts
 - ✓ Food grains
 - ✓ Living beings
 - ✓ Luxury items
3. Market Superintendent had responsibility to implement these regulations.

IMPACT:

- Revenue increased to a great extent and hence soldiers could be paid cash salaries.
- Inflation was controlled in urban centres.
- Traders zeal was decreasing due to too many regulations.
- Nobles and Amirs, being among the rich in the society were disillusioned.
- The economic regulations were hampering market forces and could continue only to Alauddin was in power.

THE KHALJI DYNASTY (1290-1320)

ALAUDDIN KHALJI (1296-1316)

ALA-UD-DIN KHILJI'S POLICIES TOWARDS MARKET REFORMS



- 1** Alauddin chose to pay his soldiers salaries in cash rather than iqta.
- 2** The soldiers would buy their supplies from merchants in Delhi and it was thus feared that merchants would raise their prices. To stop this, Alauddin controlled the prices of goods in Delhi.
- 3** Alauddin Khalji established four separate markets in Delhi
 - ✓ For grain
 - ✓ For cloth, sugar, dried fruits, butter and oil
 - ✓ For horses, slaves and cattle
 - ✓ For miscellaneous commodities.

KHALJI DYNASTY

JALALUDDIN KHALJI
[1290 AD – 1296 AD]

ALAUDDIN KHALJI
[1296 AD – 1316 AD]

QUTUBUDDIN MUBARK
SHAH
[1316 AD – 1320 AD]

NASIR – UDDIN KHUSRAU
SHAH
[1320 AD]

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- 4 Each market was under the control of a high officer called **Shahna-i-Mandi**.
- 5 The supply of grain was ensured by holding stocks in government store-houses.
- 6 Regulations were issued to fix the price of all commodities.
- 7 A separate department called **Diwan -i-Riyasat**, was created under an officer called **Naib-i-Riyasat**.
- 8 Its primary function was to implement the economic regulations issued by the Sultan and control the markets and prices.

KHALJI DYNASTY

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[1290 AD - 1296 AD]

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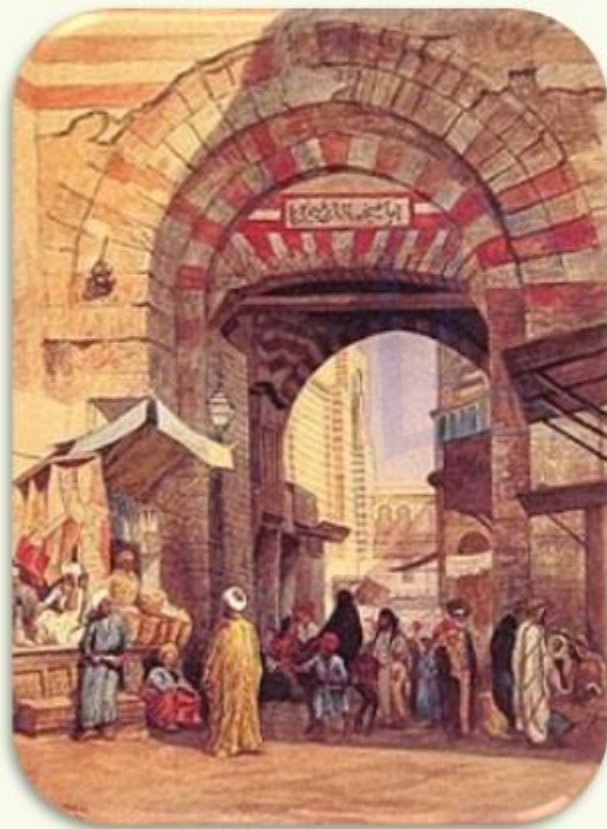
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- 9 Every merchant was registered under the Market department.
- 10 There were secret agents called *munhiyans* who sent reports to the Sultan regarding the functioning of these markets.
- 11 The Sultan also sent slave boys to buy various commodities to check prices.
- 12 Harsh punishment was given if any shopkeeper charged a higher price, or tried to cheat by using false weights and measures.
- 13 Even during the famine, the same price was maintained. (No hoarding or immoral profiteering)

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14 The prices of essential commodities were fixed which were less than the usual market rates

15 Alauddin Khalji was also particular on quickly resolving grievances with respect to affairs in the market that were brought to him

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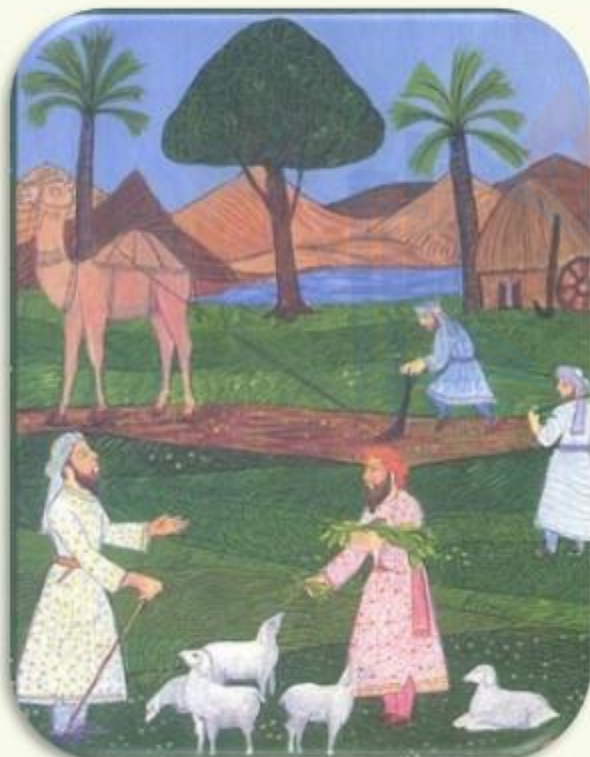
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THE KHALJI DYNASTY (1290-1320)

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**LAND REVENUE ADMINISTRATION REFORMS
BY ALA-UD-DIN KHILJI**



- 1** He was the first Sultan of Delhi who ordered for the measurement of land.
- 2** After measurement, the revenue from the land was assessed according to the measurement of land.
- 3** Even the big landlords could not escape from paying land tax.

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LAND REVENUE ADMINISTRATION REFORMS
BY ALA-UD-DIN KHILJI

- 4 Land revenue was collected in cash so he can pay the soldiers in cash.
- 5 His land revenue reforms provided a basis for the future reforms of Sher Shah and Akbar.
- 6 To know about the revenue errors and collect them, he introduced a new department of *Diwan-i-mustakhraj*.



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